PRINCE LEBURU

ACADEMIC LEADER AND HIGHER EDUCATION SCHOLAR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Academic leader and higher education specialist with two decades of experience in South African private higher education. Currently Programme Manager in the Commerce Faculty at Rosebank International and a PhD candidate in Education at the University of Cape Town. Brings sustained responsibility for programme quality and academic staff development. This work also encompasses assessment assurance and student success across contact and distance-learning environments. Scholarly work examines decolonisation and epistemic justice. It also considers the institutional conditions shaping curriculum change. Professional practice is grounded in rigorous academic governance and humane leadership that helps lecturers teach well and students find their footing.

CORE EXPERTISE

- Academic leadership and staff performance
- Higher education teaching and learning
- Student success and academic support
- Curriculum and programme development
- Assessment quality assurance and academic governance
- Academic staff development and professional learning
- Online and distance education
- Technology-enhanced learning
- Scholarship of Teaching and Learning
- Postgraduate supervision and scholarly engagement

EDUCATION AND DOCTORAL RESEARCH

PhD in Education (Candidate)
University of Cape Town
Thesis: Exploring Pathways and Frameworks to Decolonise Private Higher Education in South Africa: A Critical Realism Foray

Master of Education: Higher Education Studies
University of Cape Town | Cum laude

Postgraduate Diploma in Higher Education
Vaal University of Technology | Cum laude

Baccalaureus Technologiae (BTech): Marketing Management
Vaal University of Technology

National Diploma: Marketing Management
Vaal Triangle Technikon (now Vaal University of Technology)

SELECTED SCHOLARSHIP AND ACADEMIC SERVICE

Leburu, P. (2026) 'The illusion of change: The unfulfilled promise of decolonisation in a South African private higher education institution', *Transformation in Higher Education, 11, a684.* DOI: 10.4102/the.v11i0.684

Leburu, P. (forthcoming) 'Unearthing the Invisible: A Critical Realist–Decolonial Framework for Reimagining Private Higher Education in South Africa', *Transformation in Higher Education. Accepted for publication, 2026.*

Leburu, P. (2026) 'Pedagogy at the Hinge', accepted conference presentation, Global Dialogues on Teaching & Learning for Flourishing Futures, Durban, 16–17 November 2026.

- Peer Reviewer: Transformation in Higher Education and The Independent Journal of Teaching and Learning (2026 – Present)
- Postgraduate Research Supervisor: Rosebank International Online (2026 – Present)
- Module Guide Writer: Postgraduate module in higher education policy, regulation and governance, MANCOSA (2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Programme Manager **March 2021 – Present**

Rosebank International | Braamfontein, Johannesburg

- Provide academic leadership across a portfolio of Commerce programmes, keeping student success central. Align faculty practice with institutional policy and quality standards.
- Recruit and manage Programme Coordinators and lecturers, including their induction into institutional practice. Formal reviews and class observations support clear performance expectations.
- Coordinate assessment design and internal moderation. Oversee academic integrity processes and review learning materials for quality and regulatory alignment.
- Lead teaching enhancement initiatives alongside structured student support. Give close attention to early risk identification and timely academic intervention.
- Guide the use of learning management systems and support effective technology-enhanced teaching across faculty programmes.
- Oversee academic resource allocation and operational planning. Prepare performance and quality reports for institutional committees.
- Contribute to programme launches and policy review. Strengthen academic governance through faculty and institutional committee work.
- Sustain an active scholarly profile through research and postgraduate supervision.
- Contribute to peer reviews and publish scholarly work. Participate in academic conferences.

Programme Manager **January 2013 – February 2021**

IQ Academy | Distance Learning

- Led academic delivery and quality across a portfolio of distance-learning programmes.
- Recruited and mentored lecturers and tutors. Used structured performance appraisal to guide their professional development.
- Designed curricula and new learning programmes in response to academic standards and institutional priorities. Industry needs also informed this work.
- Developed formative and summative assessments.
- Quality-reviewed learning materials and programme guides. Reviewed academic policies when required.
- Managed material-development projects from appointment of writers through peer review and final academic approval.
- Directed the use of Moodle for e-learning delivery. Facilitated academic development for staff and students.
- Reported on programme performance and quality matters to institutional committees. Framed clear priorities for improvement.

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Training Facilitator **January 2012 – December 2012**

SACORD Consulting (Pty) Ltd

- Facilitated New Venture Creation (NQF Level 4) and related entrepreneurship training for small and medium enterprises.
- Coached business owners in business planning and marketing strategy. Client retention formed part of this support.
- Supported enterprise registration with the CIPC. Helped participants navigate funding pathways and partner resources.
- Organised business networking opportunities and conducted site visits to monitor enterprise development.

Lecturer and Head of Department **May 2010 – December 2011**

Damelin College, Educor Group

- Lectured marketing modules and led the department's academic administration. This included timetabling and assessment processes.
- Recruited and developed lecturers. Coordinated moderation and reviewed course materials and assessments.
- Facilitated academic development for lecturers and students. Supported registration and examination operations.
- Trained and managed the Student Representative Council. Contributed to academic and community initiatives that enriched campus life.

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Lecturer **February 2006 – April 2010**

IIE Rosebank College (now Rosebank International)

- Delivered marketing modules and assessed student learning. Recommended improvements to course content and teaching practice.
- Managed academic integrity matters and coordinated support for students identified as academically at risk.
- Facilitated academic development workshops for students and lecturers.
- Supported campus communication and outreach through newsletter coordination and career guidance presentations.

INSTITUTIONAL LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

- Divisional Employment Equity Committee Member, Rosebank International (2025 – Present)
- Campus Research Committee Member, Rosebank International (2025 – Present)
- Programme Advisory Committee Member, Damelin College (2011)
- Board Member, Vaal University of Technology Community Radio Station (2005)
- Deputy President, Vaal University of Technology Student Representative Council (2004 – 2005)
- Manager, SASSU Table Tennis Team | Beijing World Student Games (2001)

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS AND DIGITAL CAPABILITY

Golden Key International Honour Society, Member
Registered Assessor and Moderator: ETDP SETA and Services SETA
Microsoft 365 productivity tools: Word and Excel
Microsoft 365 communication and presentation: Outlook and PowerPoint
Learning management systems: Brightspace and Moodle
Virtual classroom platform: Blackboard Collaborate

REFEREES

References available on request.